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Unit 9 : Trina's Special Birthday

It was Trina's birthday. She was the happiest little girl in the world. Her parents had just given her the very thing she had longed for: a new bicycle.

“Thank you so much, mommy and daddy,” the excited toddler screamed. “This is the best present ever and it even has a basket on the front for my dolls.”

“You're welcome, Trina,” her mother said. “You are so well-behaved all the time that we decided to give you exactly what you asked for.”

It was a beautiful sunny day outside and Trina immediately took advantage by taking her new bike out to the driveway so that she could try it out. She was so excited, but she still stopped for a moment to look at her old tricycle and reflect on the good times they had had together. It had been her best friend since she'd got it, but now that she was getting bigger the tiny tricycle was too small. The time for them to go their separate ways had come.

In the driveway, she stood next to her bike, not quite sure what to do. Trina looked to her mother for help.

“Can you help me on, mommy?” she politely asked.

Her mother steadied the bike as she climbed on and sat comfortably with her hands on the handlebars and her feet on the pedals.

“I'm a little afraid that I might fall over, so can you hold on to me for a while?” she nicely requested.

“Of course I can, dear.” Her mother tried to assure her that there was nothing to be worried about. “This bike has training wheels. If you start to tip over, the little wheels on the back will prevent you from falling over.”

Trina's mother walked alongside her for a while as Trina pedaled. She was a bit wobbly at first, but soon her mother wasn't even holding on anymore; though, Trina was so excited to be riding her new bike she wasn't even aware that she was doing it all by herself. Soon her mother stopped following altogether and just watched her little girl ride.

“Look at me, mommy,” Trina yelled gleefully.

“I'm so proud of you, Trina,” her mother told her. “You're getting to be a big girl.” How fast they grow up, she thought.

Trina continued to ride all afternoon until it was time to eat supper. Reluctantly she parked her bike next to the old tricycle, though this time she didn't even notice it. As she walked into the house, she gave both her parents a big hug.

“You're the best parents ever,” she said sincerely. “You've made my birthday the most special birthday ever. Thanks.”

Trina and her bike would create many happy moments together riding through the neighborhood and exploring the world around them. But eventually the tiny bike would find itself parked next to the old tricycle. Inevitably, she would outgrow it, too.